[METRIC]

UU-B-368B
November 20, 1992
SUPERSEDING
UU-B-368A
July 2, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, SPRING BACK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. Scope.

1.1. This specification covers loose leaf binders which are side opening, closed (nonseparable) spring-back type, designed for firm retention of papers when closed. The binders are equipped with a pressboard folder.

2. Applicable Specifications and Standards.

2.1. The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification:

Public Law:

Public Law 94-580 - Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (Part of U. S. Code, Title 42)

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood Cleated.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-576 - Boxes, Paper, Overlaid, Veneer Wood Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edges and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.
UU-P-31 - Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
UU-P-701 - Pressboard; Colored.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7510

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Federal Standards:

Fed.Std.123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)
Fed.Std.191/5041 - Weight of Textile Materials; Small Specimen Method.
Fed.Std.191/5100 - Strength and Elongation, Breaking of Woven Cloth; Grab Method.
Fed.Std.191/5651 - Colorfastness of textile materials to crocking.

Single copies of Federal Specifications and Standards required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Auburn, WA.

In addition to the Business Service Centers, Federal Standards, Specifications and Commercial Item Descriptions, may be obtained from GSA Specifications Unit (3FPB-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407. Their current phone numbers, should anyone ask, are (202) 708-9205, or FTS-458-9205.

Military Standards:

Mil.Std.105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
Mil.Std.129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Available from: Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM):

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

ASTM E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

Available from: American Society for Testing and Materials; 1916 Race Street; Philadelphia, PA 19103.

Technical Association of Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI):

T410 - Grammage of Paper and Paperboard (Weight per Unit Area).
T411 - Thickness of Paper, Paperboard and Combined Board.
T807 - Bursting Strength of Paperboard and Linerboard.

Available from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, GA 30348.

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3. Requirements. Binders shall meet the following requirements specified herein, when tested as specified in Table I.

3.1. Materials.

3.1.1. Book cover board. The book cover board shall have a minimum thickness of 2.97 mm (0.117"), and have a minimum bursting strength of 2963 kPascals (415 lb_f/in^2).

3.1.2. Pressboard.

3.1.2.1. Back. Pressboard shall be 0.76 mm (0.030") in thickness (average), conforming to Type I of Federal Specification UU-P-701.

3.1.2.2. Folder. Pressboard shall be 0.38 mm (0.015") in thickness, conforming to Type III of Federal Specification UU-P-701, except that a minus tolerance of 0.076 mm (0.003") in thickness will be permitted.

3.1.3. Coated Cloth.

3.1.3.1. Base Cloth. The base cloth shall be cotton drill coated on the face side as specified in 3.1.3.2.

3.1.3.2. Coating Compound. The base cloth shall be coated with any commercially available virgin plastic.

3.1.3.3. Finished Coated Cloth. The breaking strength shall be at least 34 pounds in both warp and filling directions. The weight shall be 375, +68, -34 gm/m^2 (11.07, +2,-1 oz/yd^2). Colorfastness shall be at least "Good".

3.1.3.4. Flexibility. The coated cloth shall be sufficiently soft and pliable for binder operations. The coating shall not crack through to the base cloth.

3.1.3.5. Color and finish. The coated cloth shall be black and shall have a grain or finish simulating that of genuine leather.

3.1.4. Steel (springs). Steel shall be 1075 Annealed Spring Steel, 0.432 ± 0.02 mm (0.017 ± 0.001") thick, hardened and tempered to a Rockwell Superficial Hardness of 69-72 on the 30-N Scale.

3.1.5. Canvas. The breaking strength shall be at least 445 Newtons (100 pounds) in warp direction, and 267 Newtons (60 pounds) in filling direction. Canvas shall be cotton (Army) duck consisting of 2-ply yarns in both the warp and filling direction. The duck shall have a finished weight of not less than 237 gm/m^2 (7.0 oz/yd^2). Colorfastness shall be at least "Fair". Canvas

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shall be black or blue.

3.1.6. Red flexible board (reinforcement). Red flexible board reinforcement material of back shall be at least 0.762 mm (0.030") thick.

3.1.7. Paper lining. Paper lining shall have a basis weight of at least 98 gm/m^2 (60 lb_m based on 24" x 36" - 500 sheets). The color of the lining shall harmonize with the binding material.

3.2. Construction. Each binder shall be constructed to withstand the strains, jars, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, and severe office service. The binder shall consist of two stiff covers and a closed rounded back, containing four steel springs. Back and covers shall be bound with coated cloth. Coated cloth shall be one piece of material without splices, scratches, tears or cuts. Binders shall be side-opening and shall be designed and constructed in a manner that the back expands or opens sufficiently to permit insertion and removal of sheets of a quantity in accordance with the full capacity of the binder. Covers shall open and spring back to closed position in the normal manner. Each binder shall be equipped with an inner removable pressboard folder.

3.2.1. Covers. Covers shall be made of book cover board bound with coated cloth securely glued to the entire area of contact with the back and covers. The binding material shall be carried over the inside surfaces of the covers at least 1.6 cm (5/8") beyond the edges. A paper lining shall be securely glued to the inner surfaces of the covers and shall overlap the edges of the binding material at least 1 cm (3/8") and the edges of canvas reinforcement extending from the back, approximately 5 cm (2"), (see 3.2.2). All corners of the nonbinding side of the binder shall be rounded.

3.2.2. Back and springs (binding mechanism). Back shall be of pressboard, rounded, and joined to the covers by the binding material and the canvas lining of the back. The interior of the back shall be lined with a double thickness of canvas which shall extend over the inner surfaces of the covers at least 5.72 cm (2-1/4"). The exterior of the back, under the binding material, shall be cushioned with red flexible board which shall extend over the entire pressboard back and the metal strips. The binder shall contain four round, steel springs spaced along the binding edge of the pressboard back, encased in the red flexible board, and sealed with two metal strips mounted on edges of the pressboard back. Springs shall be 3.18 ± 0.16 cm (1-1/4 ± 1/16") long, (along binding edge), with ends terminating on the two metal strips along the pressboard back. Spacing of the springs shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

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3.2.3. Pressboard Folders. Folders shall be of one piece construction and shall be approximately 28 x 48 cm (11" x 19") in size. Folders shall be shaped and scored parallel to the binding edge of binder in a manner to fit the back and remainder of the binder, as applicable, in a snug manner and to accept and enclose applicable size and number of sheets ranging to the full capacity of the binder. Folders shall be inserted in the binder and shall be the manufacturer's normal commercial color.

3.3. Size and capacity. Unless otherwise specified, binder shall be not less than 28 x 21.6 cm (11" x 8-1/2") sheet size (the first dimension being the binding side), and have a minimum of 5.1 cm (2") capacity.

3.4. Identification marking. The manufacturer's name of trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable, shall be printed, heat stamped , or otherwise permanently marked on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the words "Property of U.S. Government," or any additional marking shall be included in the marking.

3.5. Workmanship. Binders shall open and close easily during the normal use, and shall be well finished, with clean, and smooth edges. Corners shall be neatly pleated or turned in accordance with normal commercial practice. Binders shall be free from any defects which may affect its serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1. Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2. Quality Conformance Inspection. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with Mil.Std.105, using the plans specified in Table I below. The lot shall consist of all samples manufactured by the same process, from the same components, submitted for inspection at one time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.

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TABLE I

Inspection Type	AQL (%)	Inspection Level	Sample Unit	Req. Paragraph	Test Method
Book Cover Board: Thickness Bursting Strength	4.0	S-4	5000 cm^2 (800 in^2)	3.1.1	TAPPI T 411 TAPPI T 807
Back	4.0	S-4	5000 cm^2 (800 in2)	3.1.2.1	*
Folder	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.1.2.2	*
Base Cloth	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.1.3.1	*
Finished Coated Cloth and Canvas: Breaking Strength Weight Colorfastness	4.0	S-4	5000 cm^2 (800 in^2)	3.1.3.3 3.1.5	Fed.Std.191 5100 5041 5651 Munsell Scale
Color and Finish	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.1.3.5	*
Steel (springs)	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.1.4	ASTM E 18
Red Flexible Board	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.1.6	
Thickness					TAPPI T 411
Paper Lining	4.0	S-4	5000 cm^2 (800 in2)	3.1.7	TAPPI T 410
Construction	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.2	*
Size and Capacity	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.3	*
Identification Marking	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.4	*
Workmanship	4.0	S-4	1 Binder	3.5	*
Packaging, Packing and Marking	4.0	S-2	1 Shipping Container	5	*

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* Visual inspections or certificates of compliance are acceptable. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to determine the validity of the certification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1. Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, or Commercial, as specified. (see 6.2)

5.1.1. Level A. Two binders shall be packaged in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to the requirements of Federal Specifications PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Binders shall be arranged in the box with the backs alternated. Each box shall be properly secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2. Commercial. Binders shall be packaged in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2. Packing. Packing shall be level B, or Commercial, as specified. (see 6.2)

5.2.1. Level B. Twelve boxes (24 binders), packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug fitting, fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP-B-636. The minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 175 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636. When specified, shipping containers may be used that conform to style A or B, class 1 of Federal Specification PPP-B-576; domestic type, style A or B of Federal Specification PPP-B-591 or PPP-B-601; or class 2, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP-B-621.

5.2.2. Commercial. Binders shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3. Marking.

5.3.1. Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contractor or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed.Std.123.

5.3.2. Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Mil.Std.129.

6. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

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7. ORDERING DATA. Purchasers should specify the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

a) Title, number and date of this specification.
b) Sheet size and capacity of the binder required.
c) Color of binder required.
d) Spacing of metal fasteners required.
e) Type and thickness of the pressboard required.
f) Unit of issue and quantity required.
g) Packaging, packing, marking and special marking required.

User Interest:

Army - GL

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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